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INDIA JEWELLERY · CONSUMER LANDSCAPE STUDY 2026

2,625 Indian jewellery buyers told us how they choose, spend and trust.

First-hand evidence for jewellery brands: why the family jeweller still wins, what holds back online and lab-grown, and how the next generation of buyers is rewriting the brief.

2,625	180	21	100%
verified consumers sharing how they buy, wear and value jewellery	cities and towns across 32 states, Tier 1, 2 and 3 India	behavioural signals, from channel and ticket size to lab-grown intent	zero-party: every consumer finding is first-hand, none scraped or modelled



Minimal, light rings: the Gen Z brief



A 999 silver bar, bought as wealth



A known brand, kept on trust



Big-brand box, bought on trust

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Jewellers are chosen on **heritage** and **relationship**, not price. 77% and 76% name them; 12% name celebrity ads.

THE BATTLEGROUND

48% say "maybe" to lab-grown over natural diamonds: the most winnable customer in the category.

THE ONLINE CEILING

Half cap a single online purchase at **₹10,000**. 76% would spend less online than they do in store.

THE NEXT BUYER

71% of Gen Z prefer minimalist design, vs 34% of older buyers. Same stores, different product.

WHY THIS MATTERS NOW

The market now rewards jewellers who truly know their buyer.

Gold prices are reshaping what India buys, organised chains are taking share from standalone stores, and a younger buyer is arriving with a different brief. Most brands still read that buyer through footfall and billing data, not first-hand evidence.

THE MARKET · SECONDARY SOURCES

₹8.3 trn → ₹12 trn

India retail jewellery, FY25 to FY29, with organised chains rising from 37 to 42% to 44 to 49% of the market.[1]

5 big bets in 18 months

Aditya Birla launched Indriya (₹5,000 Cr plan); Trent (Pome) and Titan (beYon) entered lab-grown. BlueStone listed and GIVA raised ₹530 Cr.[1,2,3,4]

#2 globally

India is now the world's second-largest diamond jewellery market (₹49,700 Cr, 2025); 18 to 28 year olds drive 51% of value.[5]

FIRST-HAND: WHAT 2,625 CONSUMERS TOLD US

A trust-led category, held as wealth, worn every day and bought in person

86.0% see gold and jewellery as a wealth-creation tool

60.0% buy jewellery at least once a year

59.2% of women wear jewellery every day

56.0% discover new jewellers through family and friends

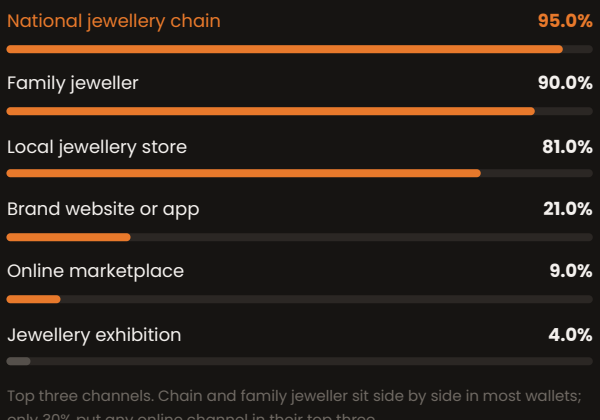
77.1% say gold price movement triggers an investment purchase

What matters most when choosing a jeweller



Top three, so shares sum to 300%. Trust signals outrank price by more than two to one; paid fame barely registers.

Where they actually buy



Top three channels. Chain and family jeweller sit side by side in most wallets; only 30% put any online channel in their top three.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOUR BRAND

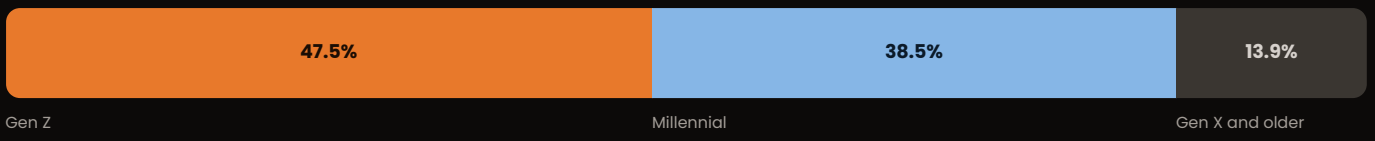
Your buyer holds jewellery as savings, wears it daily and most return to the counter every year. They are not loyal to one store: 85% buy from both a national chain and a family jeweller. The brands that grow know **which trust signal** tipped the last purchase, not just that it happened.

Consumer data: Altilos zero-party study, India, n=2,625. Market data: numbered sources on page 6.

GEN Z VS OLDER BUYERS

Gen Z changes what they buy, not where they buy it.

We segmented every respondent by generation, then compared how each group chooses, buys and spends. The product brief has split in two. The trust brief has not.



SHARE OF EACH GROUP	GEN Z	OLDER
WHAT THEY WANT		
Prefer minimalist or modern design	70.9%	33.6%
Prefer traditional or heritage design	16.4%	34.6%
Prefer heavy sets	9.6%	18.5%
WHAT THEY WEAR		
Prefer silver	50.1%	30.9%
Prefer diamond	55.2%	43.6%
HOW OFTEN AND FOR WHOM		
Buy more than twice a year	28.0%	12.1%
Buy for their own collection	36.3%	20.1%
Buy for birthdays	42.0%	24.1%
WHAT MOVES THEM		
Cap online spend at ₹10,000	61.9%	39.6%
Drawn to lab-grown by sustainability	55.4%	25.6%

Gen Z n=1,248; Millennial and older n=1,377. Every gap shown differs at $p<0.001$ (two-proportion z-test).



Gen Z: minimal, light, everyday rings

What does not change

Gen Z is no more online: 28.0% put an online channel in their top three, vs 31.7% of older buyers. Heritage (75.6%), jeweller relationship (77.0%) and word of mouth (56.4%) matter just as much. Influencers move only 13.4%.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOUR BRAND

The youngest buyer is not a digital-first defector. They walk into the same stores, trust the same signals, and spend similar amounts in person. What they want on the counter is different: lighter, minimal, silver and diamond, bought more often and for themselves. The edge comes from knowing **which pieces and price points** convert them, before you redesign a collection.

Altilos zero-party study, India, n=2,625. Generation from respondent age. Gen Z also skews lower income (21% under ₹15,000 a month).

WHAT SELLS TO WHOM

The line falls at 30. Below it, light and modern. Above it, heritage and fusion.

Cut by six age bands, design style, weight and metal shift sharply around 30. The pieces people buy, and gold's role as wealth, barely move.

Preferred style, weight and material by age

AGE GROUP, % OF EACH	18–19 n=123	20–25 n=809	26–30 n=390	31–40 n=724	41–50 n=411	51+ n=168	All
DESIGN STYLE							
Minimalist or modern	74.8	69.2	66.2	33.3	33.6	34.5	51.3
Traditional or heritage	11.4	17.4	20.8	33.6	34.8	35.7	26.0
Fusion or Indo-western	8.1	9.1	7.9	23.3	22.1	22.6	15.7
Statement or bold	5.7	4.2	5.1	9.8	9.5	7.1	7.0
WEIGHT							
Lightweight everyday pieces	53.7	55.0	55.6	46.0	40.9	49.4	50.0
Mid-weight pieces	26.0	25.7	21.0	25.6	30.7	25.0	25.7
Heavy sets	7.3	8.8	12.8	19.1	19.7	15.5	14.3
METAL AND STONE							
Gold (n.s.)	95.1	97.4	98.7	97.4	97.6	98.8	97.6
Diamond	51.2	58.0	46.9	49.2	38.2	36.3	49.1
Silver	55.3	48.7	46.2	28.7	34.8	33.9	40.0
Precious gemstones (n.s.)	17.9	19.2	16.2	18.1	18.5	18.5	18.2
Platinum (n.s.)	17.9	10.4	13.8	13.8	11.4	8.9	12.3

Brighter cells mark each row's highest values. Style and weight are single choice; metal and stone are multi-select. Shaded rows differ by age at p<0.001 (chi-square); n.s. = no significant difference.

UNDER 30

68.8% vs 33.5%

prefer minimalist design, vs buyers over 30. They also lean silver (48.6% vs 31.3%) and diamond (54.1% vs 44.1%), and 60.6% cap online spend at ₹10,000.

20 TO 25

51.7% vs 24.1%

buy jewellery for birthdays, vs every other age. They are also the self-purchase peak: 44.7% buy for their own collection, vs 20.3% of everyone else.

OVER 30

22.9% vs 8.7%

prefer fusion or Indo-western, vs under 30s. Heavy sets double (18.8% vs 9.8%), and they buy less often but will commit larger tickets online.

What does not change with age: the pieces

Bought or would buy online · all ages

76.0%	60.2%	42.9%	30.2%	26.2%	18.7%	8.5%
Finger rings	Earrings	Pendants and chains	Bracelets	Gold or silver coins	Bangles	Necklace sets

The piece mix is the same at 19 and at 55: no piece differs significantly by age. Nor does the money brief: gold is preferred by 95%+ of every band, around 70% see jewellery as both investment and fashion, and in-store tickets and lab-grown intent are flat across ages.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOUR BRAND

Age does not decide **what** piece sells; it decides **how** that piece should look and weigh. A ring range can serve every buyer, but the under-30 version is minimal, light and silver or diamond, while the over-30 version is fusion, heritage or heavier gold. Test design, weight and metal by age band before you split a collection.

Altilos zero-party study, India, n=2,625. Age bands from respondent age. Pieces and metals are multi-select, so shares sum above 100%.

WHAT WINS THE COUNTER VS WHAT WINS THE SCREEN

Trust closes the sale in store. Online is missing the proof.

Online is 4 to 6% of jewellery sales today, projected at 6 to 8% by FY29.[1] Our buyers explain why: the barrier is not convenience or choice. It is confidence in what they cannot touch.

55.9%
typically spend over ₹50,000 on a single purchase in store

50.2%
would spend no more than ₹10,000 on a single purchase online

75.7%
set an online ceiling below their usual in-store ticket

What stops them buying online

Can't assess quality or purity	77.2%
Hard to judge true colour or size	65.5%
Worried about fit	65.3%
Fear of fraud or fake products	45.9%
Delivery safety concerns	38.7%
Hassle of returns	30.1%

Purity doubt outranks every logistics concern. The fix is evidence, not faster delivery.

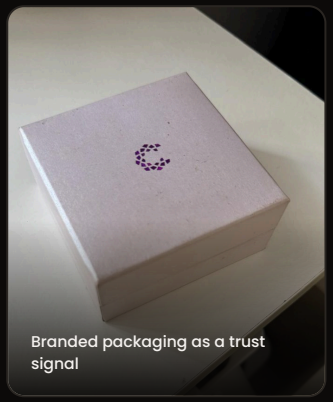
What would make them buy online

Certification of authenticity	88.6%
Money-back guarantee	78.0%
High-quality images and video	61.0%
Try-at-home service	46.8%
EMI options	33.0%
Virtual try-on (AR)	32.0%

Guarantees beat gadgets: AR try-on and wider assortment (31.8%) rank last.



AG 999 stamped: purity they can see



Branded packaging as a trust signal

48.0% vs 16.0%

would "maybe" choose lab-grown over natural, vs a firm yes. Everyday wear (43.5%) and gifting (34.2%) are where the maybes would start.

74.6%

cite low resale value as the lab-grown barrier, in a market where 86% see jewellery as wealth. Price attracts 54.3%; IGI certification 44.1%.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOUR BRAND

Online and lab-grown face the same wall: a buyer who treats jewellery as an asset and will not commit without proof. Discounts and AR will not move the ceiling. Test certification, buyback and guarantee offers with the exact buyers you want to win, **before** you scale spend behind them.

Altilos zero-party study, India, n=2,625. Barriers, triggers and occasions are multi-select, so shares sum above 100%. Occasion shares among "maybe" respondents.

FROM INSIGHT TO ACTION

One study just mapped an entire category. Your curated study shows you how to win it.

An Altilos Expert study reaches up to 750 verified consumers, scoped to your category, competitors, cities and next big decision.

Questions your study can answer

- Which chain's or family jeweller's customers will switch to you, and what proof moves them — COMPETITIVE
- Does your lightweight or lab-grown line hold up against what they wear today — VALIDATION
- What ticket size your buyer will commit online before needing a store visit, by city tier — PRICING
- Which brands and pieces are actually in their jewellery box, verified by photo — SHELF PROOF
- Which guarantee or buyback offer converts a browser into a first online purchase — CONVERSION



IN YOUR STUDY

Your switching matrix, online price ceiling and jewellery-box audit

Built from your target consumers and your named competitors. Illustrative layout shown.



PICK YOUR DEPTH · ONE-TIME, PER STUDY

Pulse	Core	Core+	Expert
₹8,000	₹40,000	₹1,00,000	₹2,00,000
50 consumers	200 consumers	350 consumers	750 consumers
Fast read on one question before you commit spend.	Validate a collection, claim or price point with your target buyer.	Competitive read across cities and segments.	Full landscape plus targeted offers to competitor users.

Know your buyer, better than the competition.

Configure your study in minutes. Decision-ready insights in days, not quarters.

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Methodology. Zero-party study of 2,625 verified consumers across 180 Indian cities and towns in 32 states, collected first-hand through Altilos' verified respondent pools (Rwazi mappers) in May 2026. Each respondent answered 21 behavioural questions on how they choose, buy, spend on and value jewellery. Margin of error ±1.9 points at 95% confidence for the full sample; subgroup comparisons tested with two-proportion z-tests and reported only where $p<0.05$. City tier is taken from each respondent's recorded city (Tier 1 32%, Tier 2 44%, Tier 3 23%). The sample skews female (78%) and young (48% Gen Z), and towards lower and middle incomes (59% earn under ₹50,000 a month), so findings best represent the mass and mass-premium buyer. A commissioned study sets quotas to your exact target, for example affluent bridal buyers aged 25 to 35 in Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities. All product photos are respondent submissions from Altilos studies.

Market sources.

1. BOB Capital Markets (BOBCAPS), Retail sector report: Glittering prospects, Sep 2025 (market size, organised and online share, BlueStone IPO and GIVA funding)
2. Indian Jeweller, Aditya Birla Group enters jewellery retail with Indriya, Jul 2024
3. Business Standard, Trent launches lab-grown diamond brand Pome, Oct 2024
4. Indian Jeweller, Titan enters lab-grown diamond jewellery with beYon, Dec 2025
5. De Beers Group, Diamond Acquisition Study 2025, via GJEPC Solitaire, Apr 2026